



MEI WU

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Capital Normal University | Ph.D. in Developmental and Educational Psychology

Research Interests: Developmental and educational psychology, with a focus on the cognitive and neural mechanisms of moral judgment and prosocial behavior in early childhood. My work integrates computational modeling with functional near-infrared spectroscopy (fNIRS) to investigate how individual characteristics (e.g., temperament, theory of mind) and family environment (e.g., parenting) shape young children's moral cognition. I am also broadly interested in the longitudinal development of prosocial behavior and its early predictors in infancy and toddlerhood.

EDUCATION

Capital Normal University Beijing, China 2022.09—2026.06

Ph.D. in Developmental and Educational Psychology Advisor: Prof. Zhengyan Wang

Dissertation: The Cognitive Processes and Neural Mechanisms of Moral Judgment in Young Children: The Role of Multi-level Predictors.

Fujian Normal University Fuzhou, China 2019.09—2022.06

M.A. in Developmental and Educational Psychology Advisor: Prof. Yingfang Meng

Quanzhou Normal University Quanzhou, China 2015.09—2019.06

B.A. in Applied Psychology

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

First-authored (and co-first-authored):

- **Wu, M.**, Liang, X., Cheng, N., Liu, J., Sun, Z., Yang, J., ... & Wang, Z. (2026). Developmental trajectory of prosocial behavior between 1 and 3 years: roles of infant and parental predictors. *Journal of Experimental Child Psychology*, 262, 106377. (SSCI, JCR Q2)
- **Wu, M.**, Liang, X., Shi, J., & Wang, Z. (2025). Individual differences in the social evaluation of 6-month-old infants. *Acta Psychologica Sinica*, 57(4), 559-572. (In Chinese, Tier 1 Core Chinese Journal)
- Lin, X., **Wu, M.**, Meng, Y., Zheng, S., & Huang, F. (2024). The impact of encoding-retrieval perceptual differences on the retrieval-divided attention effect. *Current Psychology*, 43(23), 20496-20504. (Co-first author, SSCI, JCR Q1)

Co-authored:

- Sun, Z., Cheng, N., Liu, J., **Wu, M.**, Meng, X., Liu, C., ... & Wang, Z. (2024). Stop hurting each other: Bidirectional longitudinal relationships and sex differences between parents' negative expressiveness and offspring's problem behaviors. *Early Childhood Research Quarterly*, 69, 78-87. (SSCI, JCR Q1)
- Liu, J., Bai, L., Liang, X., Yuan, S., **Wu, M.**, Dong, S., ... & Wang, Z. (2024). Mechanisms in the intergenerational effect of maternal childhood maltreatment on offspring externalizing symptoms: The role of maternal and paternal parenting. *Child Abuse & Neglect*, 155, 107004. (SSCI, JCR Q1)
- Peng, Z., Zhang, N., Lian, J., Xu, L., **Wu, M.**, Shao, Y., & Zhang, Y. (2025). Functional connectivity in table tennis players under cognitive task demands: dynamic regulation by the dominant hemisphere. *International Journal of Sport and Exercise Psychology*, 1-17. (SSCI, JCR Q2)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

National Natural Science Foundation of China (Grant No. 32471119) 2025.01—2026.06

Ph.D. Student Coordinator | *The Neural Representations and Development of Preschooler's Parent-Child Attachment: The Joint Effects of Early Multilevel Parent-Child Interaction Synchrony*

- Contributed to grant proposal preparation, experimental design, and budget planning during the project's launch phase.
- Coordinated the overall operation of the longitudinal cohort, overseeing the complete assessment cycle—including participant recruitment, personnel arrangement, assessor training, parent-child fNIRS hyperscanning, questionnaires, feedback reports, and participant database maintenance.

National Natural Science Foundation of China (Grant No. 32300896) 2024.01—2026.01

Ph.D. Student Coordinator | *The Role of Behavioral and Neural Synchrony in Mother-Child Interactions on the Intergenerational Transmission of Empathy in Preschoolers*

- Served as the Ph.D. student leader, supervising a team of master's students and coordinating the full assessment process for over 130 families.
- Designed and implemented experimental protocols; served as the primary experimenter in collecting mother-child interaction data via fNIRS hyperscanning.
- Supported by this grant and NSFC Grant No. 32471119, research outputs include a first-author paper published in the *Journal of Experimental Child Psychology*.

National Natural Science Foundation of China (Grant No. 31971006) 2022.10—2023.12

Project Member | *Developmental Trajectories and Mechanisms of Early Childhood Problem Behaviors*

- Joined the project in October 2022 and participated through its completion; responsible primarily for behavioral and questionnaire assessments, behavioral data collection and integration, and the preparation of assessment summaries and feedback reports for over 1,000 families.

National Natural Science Foundation of China (Grant No. 31800906) 2019.01—2021.12

Project Member | *The Influence of Retrieval Interference on Implicit Memory and Its Underlying Mechanisms*

- Led key experiments, contributed to the writing of the project report, and successfully completed the project and passed the final review.
- Findings were published in *Current Psychology* (as co-first author), with one additional preprint.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- **Wu, M.,** Liang, X., Shi, J., & Wang, Z. (2023). Social Evaluation in 6-Month-Old Infants: An Extension and Validation Based on Hamlin (2007). Oral at the 4th International Conference on Early Childhood Development and Childcare. (**Outstanding Presentation**)
- **Wu, M.,** Liang, X., & Wang, Z. (2024). *Early Development of Prosocial Behavior: The Role of Infant Empathy and Parental Prosocial Tendencies*. Oral at the 17th Annual Conference of the Developmental Psychology Committee of the Chinese Psychological Society (**Outstanding Presentation**)
- **Wu, M.,** Zhang, L., Liang, X., & Wang, Z. (2025). *The Relationship Between Theory of Mind and Moral Judgment in Preschoolers: Based on the CNI Model*. Oral at the 26th National Academic Conference of Psychology.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Infant and Toddler Psychology | Teaching Assistant

2022.09—2023.03

- Contributed to syllabus revision; graded assignments; addressed students' academic inquiries.

Psychological Statistics and SPSS | Teaching Assistant

2020.09—2021.01

- Managed online backend operations and offline course administration.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Neuroimaging:** Functional near-infrared spectroscopy (fNIRS), including hyperscanning paradigm design, data acquisition, preprocessing, GLM analysis of task-state activation, and resting-state functional connectivity analysis.
- **Computational Modeling:** Multinomial Processing Tree (MPT) modeling; parameter estimation using multiTree software.
- **Statistical Software:** SPSS, R (RStudio), Mplus, MATLAB; experience with mediation, moderation, and longitudinal modeling.
- **Languages:** Mandarin (native), English (academic reading, writing, and presentation).

HONORS & AWARDS

- **Scholarships:** First-Class (CNU, 2023, 2024); Second-Class (CNU, 2022, 2025); Third-Class (FNU, 2020, 2021; QNU, 2016); Outstanding Social Worker Scholarship (QNU, 2017, 2018)
- **Awards:** Outstanding Graduate Award (FNU, 2022); Outstanding Graduate Award (CNU, 2026)